

Metro Atlanta Hail and 60 MPH Winds: What to Inspect on Your Roof

Patch reported that severe storms were forecast to reach Metro Atlanta and north Georgia on Tuesday, July 28, 2026, with the severe risk lingering into the overnight hours (Source: [patch.com](https://patch.com/atlanta/news/atlanta-forecast-severe-storm-july-28-2026), July 2026). The same forecast warned of hail up to a dime size and wind gusts up to 60 mph accompanying Monday's storms, with quarter-size hail possible as the broader system moved through - and hail at either size can bruise shingles and strip protective granules without leaving obvious signs from the ground. Cobb, Gwinnett, and Fulton homeowners sat squarely in the storm path.

The short answer: Dime-to-quarter-size hail and 60 mph wind gusts can damage asphalt shingles, flashing, and gutters even when your roof looks intact from the driveway - so a close post-storm inspection is the only way to catch it early. **Who this affects:** Homeowners across Cobb, Gwinnett, Fulton, Cherokee, and DeKalb counties in the July 28 storm path, especially those with roofs older than 12 years. **What to do:** Schedule a professional roof inspection to document any granule loss, dented flashing, or bruised shingles before problems spread. **Timeline:** Within 1-2 weeks of the storm, and before the next system moves through.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspection to document storm damage from angles a ground-level look misses - producing a photo-documented report that strengthens an insurance claim from day one.

What do hail and 60 MPH winds actually do to a Metro Atlanta roof?

Hail and 60 mph winds bruise shingles, loosen granules, and lift shingle edges - often invisibly. In Cobb and Gwinnett neighborhoods, wind at that speed exploits any already-loose shingle tab, breaking the seal and letting water track underneath. Hail impacts crush the granule layer that shields asphalt shingles from UV, accelerating aging even when no shingle is missing. Patch reported the storms could bring hail up to a quarter size, frequent lightning, and up to 60 mph winds across the broader Georgia system, with dime-size hail in Monday's metro Atlanta forecast (Source: [patch.com](https://patch.com/atlanta/news/atlanta-forecast-severe-storm-july-28-2026), July 2026). After a storm, check your gutters and downspout splash zones for a buildup of shingle granules - that sediment is one of the clearest early signals of hail impact.

Which Metro Atlanta neighborhoods are most exposed to this storm damage?

Older housing stock across the inner suburbs faces the highest risk from this kind of hail-and-wind event. In Marietta and Smyrna, ranch homes and split-levels from the 1970s and 1980s often still carry aging three-tab shingles that shed granules quickly under hail. Decatur and Tucker bungalows with low-slope sections drain slowly, so wind-driven rain from a 60 mph gust can back up under lifted shingles. Newer Suwanee and Johns Creek subdivisions built in the early 2000s are reaching the 15-to-20-year mark when architectural shingles start losing wind resistance. In Roswell and East Cobb, mature tree canopy raises the odds of limb strikes and debris scarring on the roof surface.

As a GAF Master Elite certified roofing contractor, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors has completed storm damage assessments across Cobb, Gwinnett, Fulton, and Cherokee counties - coverage that helps homeowners understand exactly what a given roof age and shingle type can withstand.

How does the July storm fit Atlanta's broader storm pattern?

This event fits squarely inside Atlanta's April-through-September severe-weather window, when heat and humidity fuel afternoon and evening thunderstorms. Patch noted a heat advisory with heat indices of 105-109 degrees preceding the storms - the exact instability that feeds hail-producing cells (Source: [patch.com](https://www.patch.com), July 2026). The National Weather Service warned that the storms could linger into overnight hours across metro Atlanta and north Georgia, meaning a single afternoon of hail rarely acts alone during peak season. The takeaway: documenting damage now protects you before the next round arrives.

Should I inspect my roof myself or hire a professional?

Hire a professional - climbing a wet or storm-loosened roof is dangerous, and trained eyes catch damage homeowners miss. From the ground you can safely check for granules in gutters, dented gutter faces, and displaced shingles on the lawn, but hail bruising and cracked flashing require a close, systematic look. An AI-powered drone inspection captures high-resolution imagery of every slope and penetration without anyone stepping on compromised shingles - and the resulting photo-documented report gives you a dated record of the roof's condition. If you spot even one clear sign of impact, arrange a professional roof inspection rather than waiting for a leak to appear inside.

Why are roof repair and replacement costs a bigger factor after this storm?

Deferring a post-storm inspection now carries more financial risk than in prior years because roofing labor and materials remain elevated. When a bruised shingle field goes uninspected, isolated hail damage spreads into decking rot - turning a targeted repair into a full roof replacement. Catching wind and hail damage early is the difference between a small storm damage roof repair and a five-figure new roof installation. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors offers Wells Fargo financing and provides insurance claims assistance, helping homeowners in Cherokee and Henry counties move from an approved claim to completed storm damage restoration without stalling on upfront cost.

When should Metro Atlanta homeowners consider full roof replacement instead of repair?

Consider full roof replacement when hail and wind damage is widespread across multiple slopes or when the roof is already near the end of its service life. A few wind-lifted shingles on a 6-year-old roof usually warrant repair; extensive granule loss on a 17-year-old roof in Kennesaw or Duluth often points to replacement. Architectural shingles typically last 20 to 25 years in Georgia's heat-and-humidity climate, but repeated hail events shorten that span. When we install a new roof, the CertainTeed Select ShingleMaster and GAF Master Elite certifications let us offer manufacturer warranties that a non-certified crew cannot. Ask any contractor to document damage slope by slope before recommending replacement over repair.

Metro Atlanta Area	Housing Type / Era	Storm Vulnerability	Homeowner Action
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Marietta	1970s-80s ranches, three-tab shingles	Rapid granule loss under hail	Check gutters for granule sediment; schedule inspection
Decatur / Tucker	1940s-60s bungalows, low-slope sections	Wind-driven rain backing up under lifted shingles	Inspect flashing and low-slope drainage after storm
Suwanee / Johns Creek	Early-2000s subdivisions, architectural shingles	Wind resistance declining at 15-20 year mark	Document shingle seal condition; assess wind uplift
Roswell / East Cobb	Established homes under mature tree canopy	Limb strikes and debris scarring from 60 mph gusts	Clear debris; inspect for punctures and impact marks
Kennesaw / Duluth	1990s two-story homes nearing roof end-of-life	Cumulative hail damage triggering full failure	Compare repair vs. replacement with dated documentation

FAQ

How soon after a hail storm should I get my roof inspected in Cobb County?

Schedule a professional roof inspection within 1-2 weeks of a hail event and before the next storm system arrives. The July 28, 2026 storms brought hail and 60 mph gusts across metro Atlanta, and that impact can bruise shingles without visible cracks. Waiting lets minor granule loss develop into leaks that reach the decking. A documented inspection soon after the storm also creates a clear timeline if you later file an insurance claim. Early action keeps a small repair from becoming a full replacement.

Can 60 mph winds really damage a roof that looks fine from the ground?

Yes - 60 mph winds break shingle seals and lift edges in ways that are invisible from the driveway. Patch reported gusts up to 60 mph accompanying the recent Georgia storms, and that speed is enough to loosen shingle tabs on aging roofs. Once the seal breaks, wind-driven rain tracks underneath and reaches the underlayment. A drone or hands-on inspection is the only reliable way to confirm the seal is intact. Ground-level appearance is not a dependable measure of wind damage.

What are the signs my roof has hail damage after a Georgia storm?

The clearest signs are granules collecting in gutters and downspout splash zones, dented gutter faces and metal flashing, and dark bruise marks or exposed asphalt on shingles. Hail crushes the granule layer that protects asphalt from UV, so granule sediment is often the first clue. You may also find loose shingle pieces on the lawn or dings on soft metal vents. Because bruising is hard to see from the ground, pair your visual check with a professional assessment. Documenting these signs early supports both repair planning and any claim.

Does my homeowners insurance cover hail and wind damage to my roof?

Most homeowners policies in Georgia cover sudden hail and wind damage, though your deductible and policy terms determine your out-of-pocket cost. The key is documenting the damage promptly with dated photos tied to a specific storm date. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors provides insurance claims assistance and produces a photo-documented drone report that helps substantiate a claim before the adjuster visits. Review your policy for wind and hail provisions and your deductible amount. Filing with clear documentation improves the odds of a smooth approval.

Should I file an insurance claim before or after getting a roof inspection?

Get a professional roof inspection first so you know the extent of the damage before you file. An inspection produces the documentation - photos, damage locations, and a repair scope - that supports an accurate claim. Filing blindly can lead to an estimate that understates the damage or a denied claim if impact isn't clearly shown. A dated, photo-documented report from a drone inspection strengthens your position from the start. Inspect, document, then file.

How does Atlanta's summer heat make storm damage worse for my roof?

Atlanta's summer heat weakens shingles and fuels the storms that damage them. The recent event followed a heat advisory with indices of 105-109 degrees, which is exactly the instability that generates hail-producing thunderstorms (Source: patch.com, July 2026). Prolonged heat also bakes and softens asphalt shingles, making them more brittle when hail strikes. That combination means damage compounds faster during the April-to-September peak. Regular inspections during these months catch heat-plus-hail wear before it spreads.

Is drone roof inspection better than someone walking my roof in Gwinnett?

Drone inspection is safer and often more thorough because it avoids putting weight on storm-loosened shingles that could cause further damage or injury. An AI-powered drone captures high-resolution imagery of every slope, valley, and penetration, including areas hard to reach on foot. In Gwinnett's mix of steep-pitch two-story homes, this reduces the risk of missing damage on upper slopes. The result is a comprehensive, photo-documented report you can keep for insurance and future reference. Many inspections combine drone imagery with targeted hands-on verification.

How long does an architectural shingle roof last in Georgia's climate?

Architectural shingles typically last 20 to 25 years in Georgia, though heat, humidity, and repeated hail can shorten that span. Roofs in Kennesaw, Duluth, and other suburbs that have absorbed multiple storm seasons often show wear earlier than the maximum rating. If your roof is 15 years or older and takes a hail hit, replacement may be more cost-effective than repeated repairs. A GAF Master Elite or CertainTeed-certified installation can extend usable life through manufacturer warranties. An inspection tied to your roof's age gives the clearest repair-versus-replace answer.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

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